

Modrinth is a modern, open-source platform designed for sharing Minecraft mods, datapacks, resource packs, and plugins. Launched as an alternative to CurseForge, it offers a cleaner, faster, and more user-friendly interface. Its commitment to transparency, open-source principles, and community-driven development has made it a popular choice among both creators and players. However, beneath its polished exterior lies a deeply flawed moderation system. While Modrinth presents itself as a creator-friendly platform, its enforcement of policies often contradicts its stated values. Creators are routinely subjected to rigid, opaque moderation that fails to account for the unique needs of different types of projects. For example, datapacks, which are fundamentally different from traditional mods, are frequently judged by the same rules, leading to confusion, frustration, and unnecessary rejections. One of the most significant issues is Modrinth's reliance on automated moderation tools. While automation is understandable for a platform of this size, the absence of meaningful human oversight creates a system where creators are effectively silenced. Messages are met with copy-pasted responses, detailed explanations are ignored, and genuine appeals are left unanswered. This behavior, whether from bots or moderators, erodes trust and signals that Modrinth prioritizes policy enforcement over creator support. Another concern is the platform's versioning policy. Modrinth demands that all versions of a project follow a strictly linear progression. While this makes sense for mods that rely on dependency resolution and auto-updaters, it falls apart for datapacks, which are manually installed by users. Creators who offer clear, environment-specific versions (such as Singleplayer and Multiplayer) are told to split their projects into separate pages, an illogical demand that fragments communities and confuses users. When my datapack was withheld, Modrinth stated: "Your project will remain Withheld until all moderation concerns are addressed.". They never specified what those concerns were. They never offered a path to resolution. Nine months of silence followed. That isn't a discussion. That is an indefinite condition with no way forward. Contrast this with CurseForge. Despite its older interface, CurseForge has consistently approved the same projects that Modrinth rejects. CurseForge doesn't force creators into rigid versioning structures, nor does it subject them to automated silence. It trusts creators to organize their work in a way that makes sense for their audience. Modrinth has the potential to be the better platform. Its design is superior, its performance is faster, and its ideals are admirable. But potential means nothing when the platform actively alienates the very creators it claims to serve. Until Modrinth adopts a more flexible, human-centered moderation approach, it will continue to be defeated by CurseForge, not because CurseForge is better, but because Modrinth refuses to listen.